

PROCESS

I Am Not the Sum of My Parts began with an interest in the skin and the tension between inside and outside. I started by studying different layers of the skin and translating their structures and behaviours into knitted textiles. Through microscopy, I became increasingly interested in how technologies of viewing can fragment the body: zooming in, isolating tissues, and turning a complex system into separate parts.

The first experiments developed into wearable garments, each representing a different tissue. While developing their silhouettes, I explored how biological behaviours such as contraction, cushioning, connection and protection could reshape the human body. Feedback during the project challenged me to question whether separating the tissues into four garments was repeating the fragmentation I was trying to critique.

This led to a shift from garments towards human-scale textile objects. I began combining scale, suspension and interaction to create a sensory environment rather than a collection of costumes. The TextileLab in Tilburg became an important part of this development, allowing me to push my domestic knitting experiments further on industrial machinery and letting the materials themselves influence the final forms.

The final installation brings three tissue translations together as a playful, tactile environment. Each object invites a different form of interaction, reconnecting microscopic structures with the body through touch, curiosity and wonder.